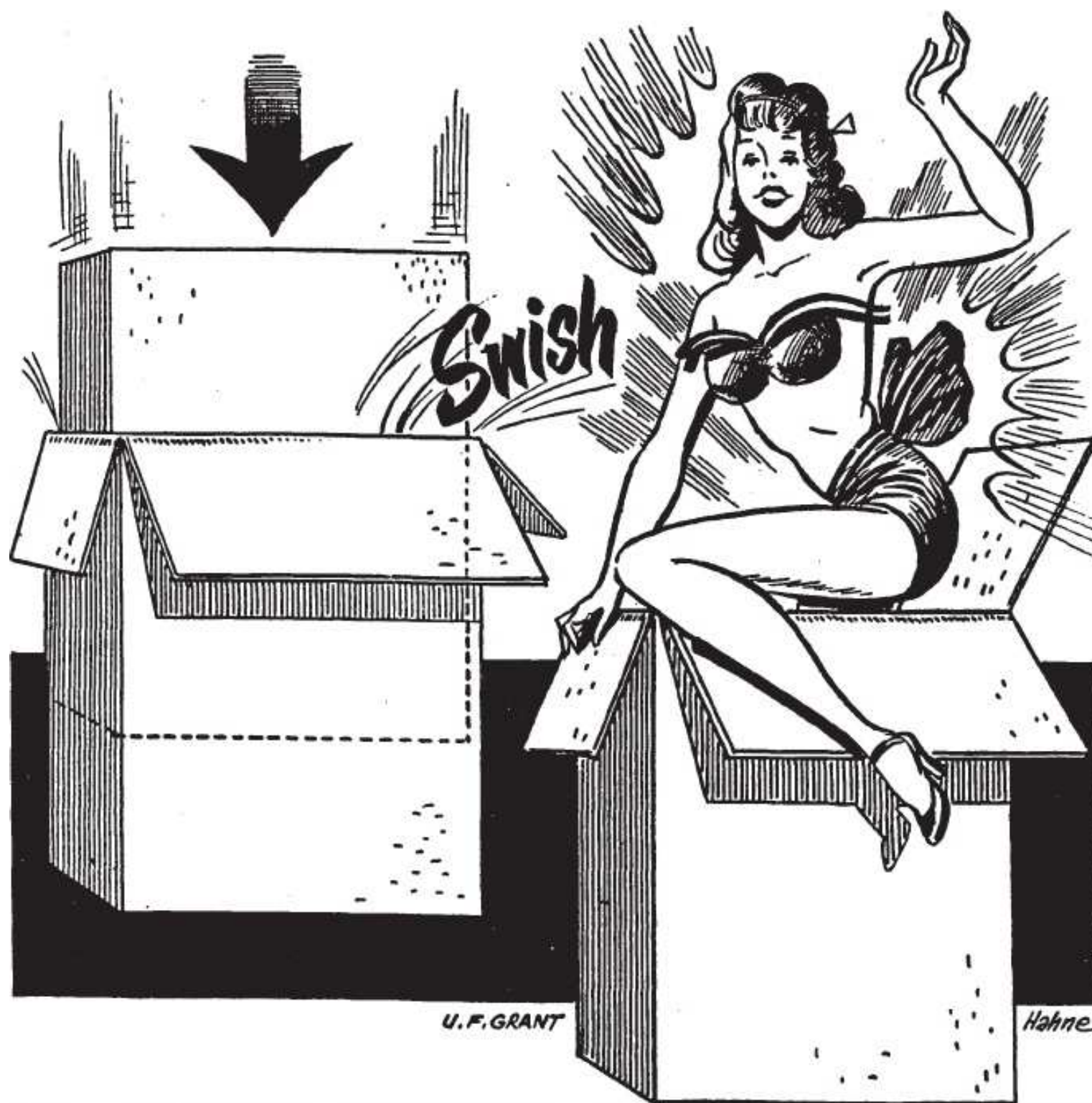


VICTORY CARTON ILLUSIONS



SAWING THRU A GIRL — LEVITATION — SUBSTITUTION — DOLL HOUSE
HEADS OFF — SPOOKS — DOG VANISH — GIRL PRODUCTION — BOY VANISH

INTRODUCTION

Victory Carton Illusions derived its name from that catchword used in the U.S. during World War II. Whilst the boys were fighting abroad, the home folks had vegetable gardens -- 'Victory Gardens'. Double lane hiways, new at that time, were named Victory Boulevard. Apartment complexes, shopping areas all fell under this wonderful esprit de corps of lets help and win the war.

With wood and metal unavailable to mere trixters, U.F. Grant conceived the idea of illusions from cardboard. The whole idea was a knock down drag out success. The Victory Carton Production, Headless Illusion, Substitution, Costume Illusion, and Victory Rabbit Carton were all marketed as complete ready made state of the art magic during World War II. Magicians bought them like there was no tomorrow. They were used successfully by magicians on U.S.O. shows and by G.I.'s the world over.

Today for different reasons many of us would like to barter some of our time and ingenuity to create some good magic. Just imagine, for a few dollars and a very little effort you can build an illusion act and carry it all flat, in the back of your car.

Some of these items may not appeal to you and some items may not appeal to others. However, the ones you find that suit your fancy, and which you spend your time and money to construct, you will find it has been spent very well.



The Where and How on Cartons

Decorating Ideas

Large cartons may be obtained from Department Stores that handle furniture items such as T.V. Sets, etc. In most large cities there are factories that manufacture cartons and they can supply you with large cartons as well as large sheets of carton material. The type you want is called "single wall 200 pound test" In the USA this is a standard cartoning material. There are many small businesses that need boxes in a variety of sizes in small quantities. These people cater to them. Check the phone directory Yellow Pages under Cartons, Boxes, etc. With these sheets of material, a utility knife and some tape, you can make just about anything you need.

With respect to tape, a GOOD HARDWARE STORE is your best shot. Gummed kraft paper tape, the kind sold for sealing boxes will work, slightly, as its life expectancy is very short. Ponder the tape situation a bit, even trying different stores. Look for a pressure sensitive cloth or vinyl backed tape. it's there, called by many different names -- duct sealing tape, weather sealing tape, bookbinders tape. Check out a sample. If it's good and sticky, difficult to tear, and doesn't crack when you fold it repeatedly, you got it!

In sealing the corners of cartons which will be folded flat for carrying, use a double thickness of tape so that it will wear well. When a carton is to have no bottom or top, and wherever there is an open edge, seal this joint with tape for protection and longer wear. This will also add to the natural look when you must use a piece of tape to hinge a flap.

The size of the cartons you will need will depend, in most cases, upon the size of the assistant you use. Some magicians use their children as assistants and are thus able to use smaller cartons.

You will be surprised at how long a carton can be used without

wearing out. We know of some magicians who have used a carton for a couple of years, before having to replace it. One performer paints his cartons to look like cabinets, however, we prefer to leave them just as they are for greater effect.

With the carton material, knife, and tape at hand, you can build one or more illusions in an evening.

Please remember, to present an illusion correctly, requires just as much, or even more practice than presenting a small trick. We ask you not to present any of these illusions without rehearsals. We know you will be sold on the effect that they have on your audience.

DECORATING

In most cases it is not a good idea not to completely paint cartons. First of all this runs the cost way up, creates a maintenance problem, and can look very corny unless you know what you are doing. Secondly, you are trying to make the carton tricks into something they just are not. If you feel that paint is necessary and unavoidable, here is the general procedure: Keep the painted areas confined to those parts that are free from hinges, flaps, etc. Avoid the use of house paints, lacquer, enamel, or stains. These materials will either soak in or crack and have poor adhesion.

What you must first do is to apply a coating to seal the pores of the cardboard and thus provide a foundation for succeeding paints. Shellac or varnish will do the job well, especially considering the cost factor. Polyurethane finishes and other exotic types are great, but to go that route---BRING BIG BUCKS.

Again, back to the hardware or paint store. Ask questions. What you are attempting here is not at all unusual and practically any dealer would be able to have all the materials ready at hand. You must take extreme care however, to be certain that all the paint products will be compatible with one another. There is such a wide variety of chemicals out there and so many people involved in their concoction that throwing just anything together is a new way to spell disaster. Fortunately, most of this information is printed on can labels. If you are able to buy everything from one

source, so much the better.

My alternate suggestion to all this would be geometrical designs. These can be very contemporary, chic, bold, brilliant and easily seen at a distance. And that's the name of the game --- seen at a distance. Most good art supply stores have racks of inexpensive books on design. \$3.00 or \$4.00 books. Many geometric designs are computer generated today. Go to video arcades and look on the sides of the machines, in stores at the toy and game boxes. In short keep your eyes open. If you really have a bad eye for this sort of thing seek out an elementary or high school art teacher and make friends. To someone who deals with these type of designs it comes easy. Don't fight it get help.

First lay out the design lightly in pencil on the carton panel. Then do the final over that. For the actual trimming you can use flourescent tapes, contact paper, wall covering materials, cloth, in fact anything that will stay put and wear. Keep in mind that the basic carton color will provide the base color and your designs must contrast with that. After you get the design roughed in run back about 10 or so feet and do your admiring. Remember-- seen from a distance.

IN AGAIN OUT AGAIN

This illusion is extremely easy to build and easy to present.

Briefly, the effect is this: After introducing your little boy or girl assistant, you have them step into a carton. YOU can immediately show the carton to be empty, your assistant having vanished!!

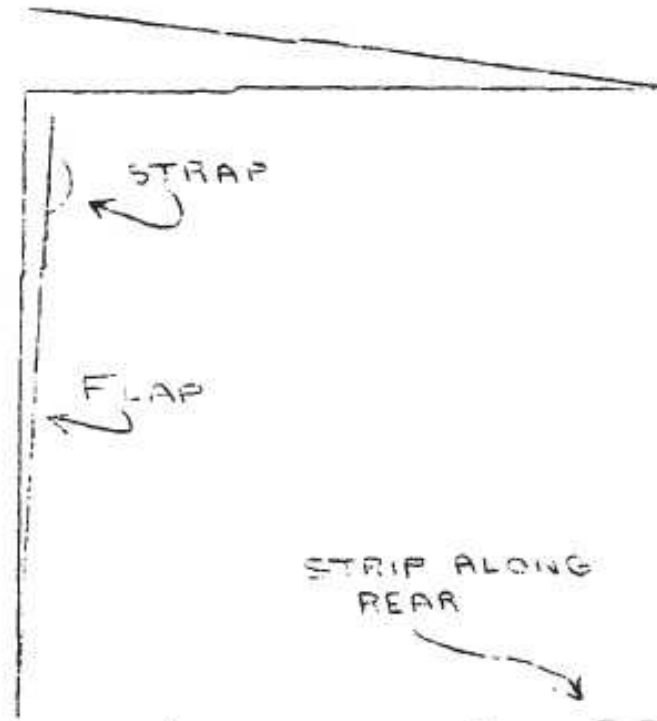
The carton used in this case is actually a tip-over box. The size of the carton used will, of course, depend upon the size of your assistant. Figure-1 shows a side view of the carton. You will notice the carton is bottomless but it has a one inch strip remaining along the rear edge of the bottom. A flap, the exact size of the bottom, is hinged to the front of the carton, as illustrated. Attached to this large flap is a strap. The carton also has a hinged lid.

In presentation, have a large board resting on, and extending between the seats of two chairs. The carton rests on this board so that it is up off the floor.

After introducing your small assistant, open the lid on the carton and have your assistant step inside. The lid is then closed. Now, your assistant holds the strap on the flap in order to hold the flap upright. You tip the box toward the audience. Illustrated in Figure-2. When you open the carton it will appear empty. The flap will now appear as the bottom of the carton. Your assistant is concealed behind the carton. Close the lid and, after setting the carton upright again, you may reproduce your assistant if desired.

By having your assistant out in the audience you can apparently get a member of the audience up to the stage and cause them to vanish.

In Again - Out Again



(SIDE VIEW)

FIG 1

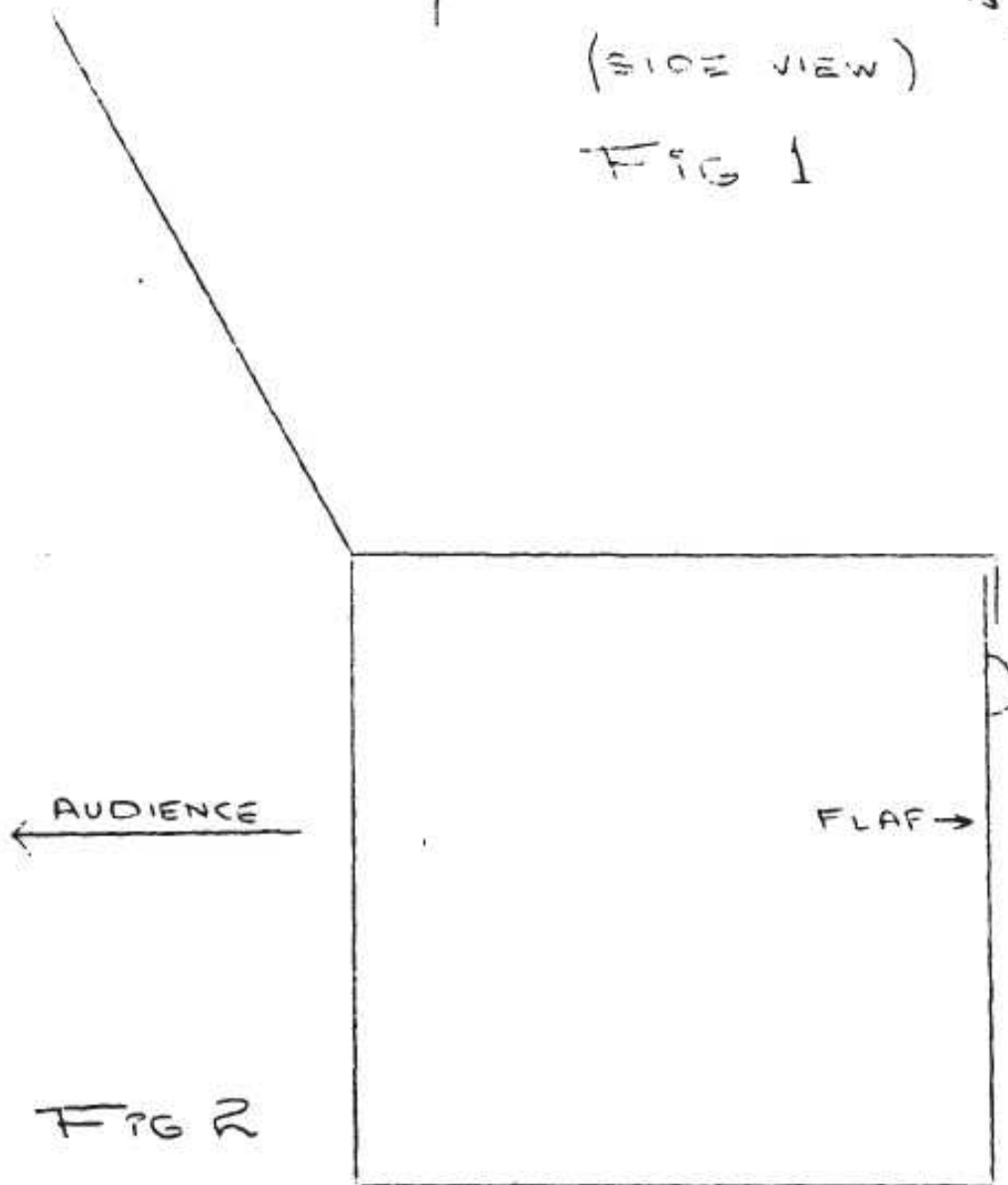


FIG 2

SAWING THRU A GIRL

What magician hasn't wanted to do the Sawing Thru A Girl Illusion!! It is associated with magic as much as pulling a rabbit out of a hat. Unfortunately, few magicians ever succeed in adding this to their program. One of the reasons is the financial aspect. As in most large illusions, the cheapest ones run into three figures. The Victory version of this famous illusion puts it within the reach of everyone. Like the preceeding illusion, this one is extremely easy to construct.

The carton used for this illusion is a short, high box with a hinged lid at the top. There are two holes in one end thru which the feet of the assistant will pass. Three holes are provided in the opposite end thru which the head and hands of your assistant pass. The length of the carton will be determined by the height of your assistant. It should be of such a length that the assistant is not stretched out to her full length, when she is in the carton. The carton must be high enough for her to draw back her legs as described later.

In presentation, the carton rests across the seats of four chairs which are in a row facing the audience. There should be a little space between the two center chairs. Since, it is at that point, you will do the sawing. After displaying the carton, (you can even tip it over and let the audience look into it) you introduce your assistant and she steps into it. Her head and hands go thru the holes in one end. Her feet are placed thru the holes in the other end. The lid is then closed. Figure-1 shows the girl in the carton.

Standing at the rear center of the carton, you start sawing down thru the center of the carton. The saw used should be a thin bladed two handled saw. When you have sawn about half way thru the carton, the girl lets out a scream. Now, we come to a vital part of the illusion. The following actions take but a few seconds. It is important that they be executed smoothly and precisely. They will require patient rehearsal.

As soon as the girl screams you stop sawing. The saw should be resting straight across the carton as shown in Figure-2. You then quickly step to the foot of the carton, apparently to see what is the matter. Actually your purpose is to conceal the fact that the girl draws her feet back into the carton. You stand at the front corner so that the feet are concealed from view by the audience. If you are working with another assistant, you can remain at the rear of the carton. Your other assistant then rushes out and stands in position to conceal the feet.

The girl draws her feet in and doubles up her legs, drawing them back under the saw, Figure-3. She then extends them over the saw and back out the holes. This takes only seconds, and then apparently satisfied, everything is all right again, you resume sawing and cut the carton completely in two. The carton is opened and the girl steps out unharmed.

Since this carton must be of a particular size to fit your assistant, you have to make it from sheets of carton material. Bind all openings with tape for longer wear. You can use the same carton over and over by simply adding a strip of carton material to the center. It is this strip that is cut each time. Make it about 6 or 8 inches wide and it will overlap 3 or 4 inches. Add this extra piece to all four sides or just the front and back. It is only this strip that you cut each performance. Figure-4.

Sawing Through A Girl

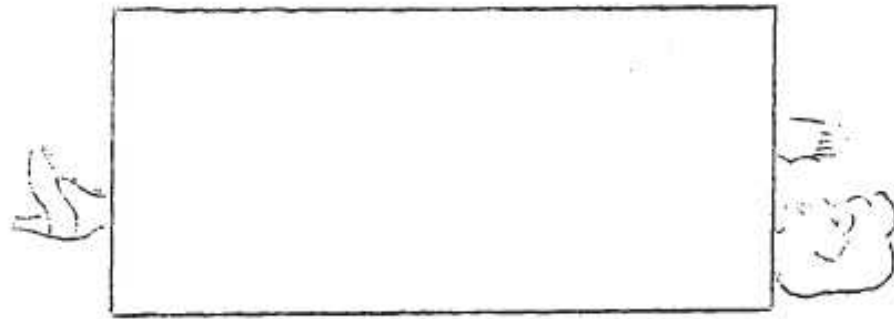


FIG. 1

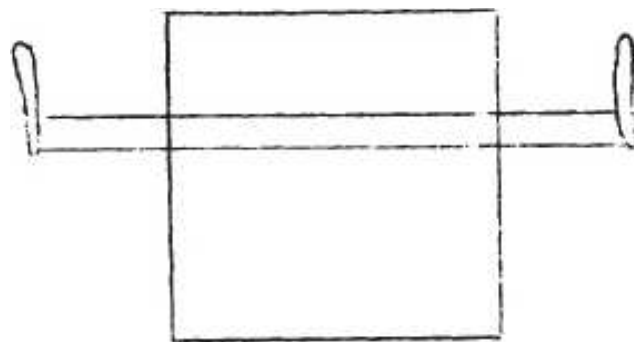


FIG. 2

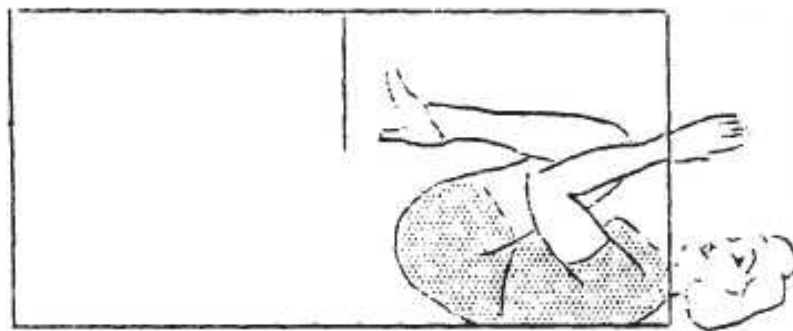
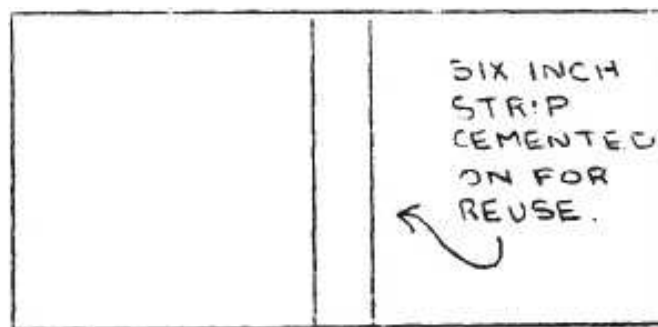


FIG. 3



SIX INCH
STRIP
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ON FOR
REUSE.

FIG. 4

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VICTORY RABBIT CARTON

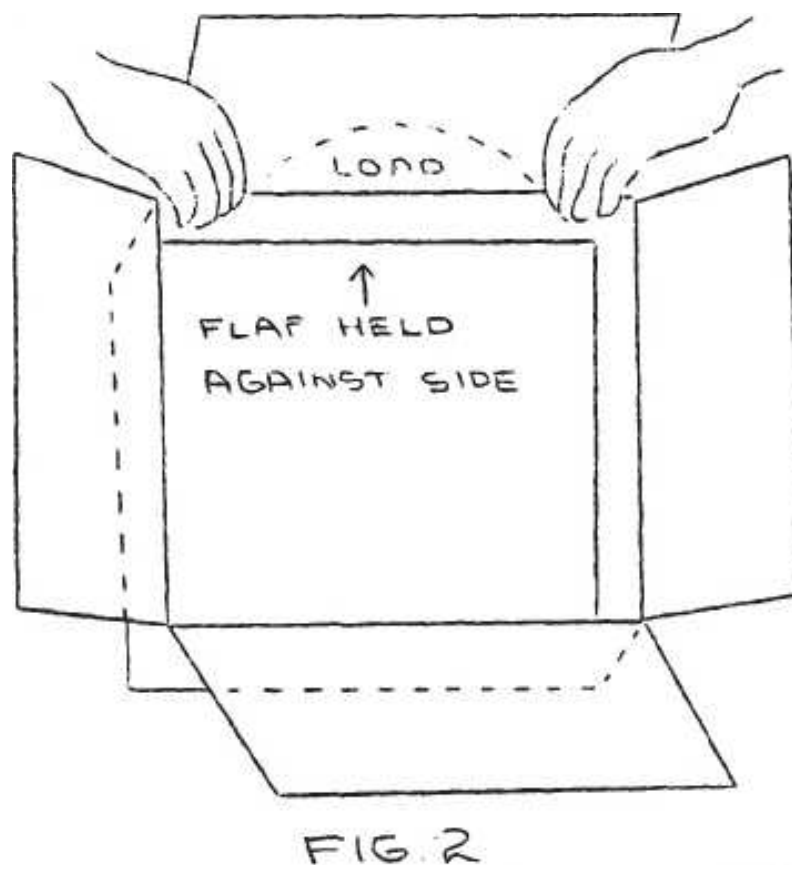
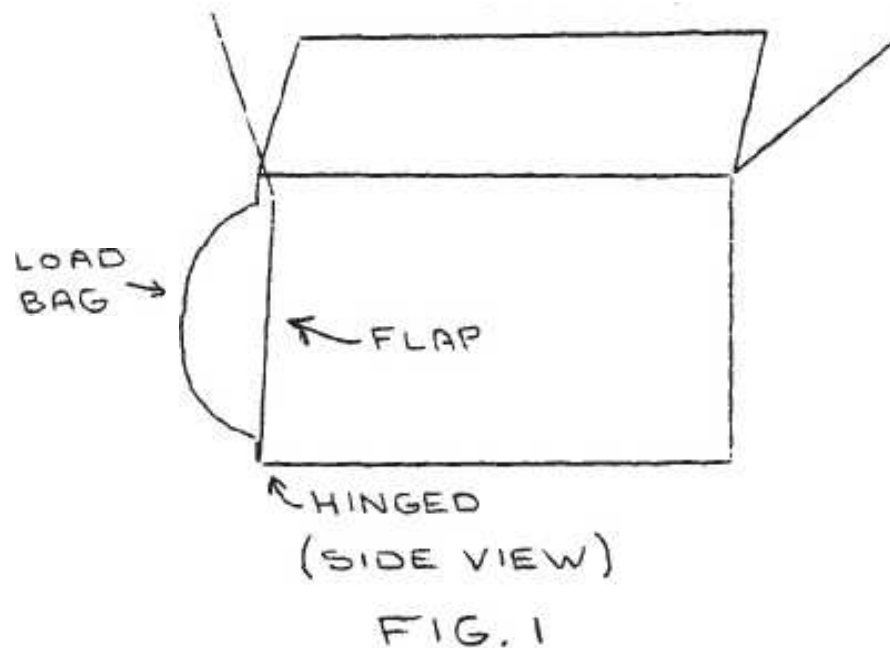
This is one of the most popular of all the Victory Carton Effects. It has been used by many of the leading magicians in the country. We think it's popularity may be due to the fact that it is so versatile. It can be used for many things but in our description here, we will describe the production of a rabbit. It can be used to produce other items or to exchange a rabbit as well as vanish a rabbit.

You will probably be able to obtain the proper size cartons from a store. Two the same size will be required to make one trick. They must be about fourteen inches square and about nine inches deep. The bottom of one carton is removed. Cut a large opening in one side of either carton. A load bag is attached to this opening on the outside of the carton using brass paper fasteners. The top flap is cut off of just this one side. All other top flaps are left on.

From the other carton cut just one side out, along with the top flap. This side and flap is then fastened inside the first carton on the side which carries the load bag. This piece is hinged at the bottom only. See Figure-1. With the carton opened out, this extra flap may be pushed in towards the center giving access to the load bag. Or, it also may be pushed against the side, thus concealing the load chamber.

In presentation, have a rabbit loaded in the bag. The carton is folded flat and you are all set. Exhibit the flat carton and then open it out, keeping the load to the rear. Holding the flap against the side, turn the carton towards the audience so that they can see through it. See Figure-2. The load bag will be concealed by the top flap as illustrated. After thus showing the carton empty, set it on the table. The load bag, naturally, is to the rear. Move the flap in towards the center of the carton as you reach in and produce the rabbit from the load bag. At the conclusion, the carton may be again folded flat and laid aside.

Victory Rabbit Carton



VICTORY SUBSTITUTION

The substitution effect has made the reputation of many a performer. Properly presented, it is a fascinating thing to watch and never fails to draw applause. You will not find a more economical method than this. This effect is the easiest of the Victory Illusions to make.

You can probably obtain the right type of carton from a department store. It should be large enough to contain either you or your assistant. The only preparation is that you cut four small holes in the front and also in the back of the carton. This is shown in Figure-1. In performing, you merely say that these are air holes, since the carton would otherwise be sealed tight. In addition to the carton, you will need a folding screen which can be moved in front of the box to conceal it from the audience at the appropriate time.

In presenting, you exhibit the carton and show that the bottom is securely sealed. Your assistant is then introduced and she steps into the carton. You then fold down the top flaps and seal them securely with gummed tape. While you are sealing the top, your assistant cuts a large square hole out of the back of the carton. She does this using a small razor blade that was concealed on her person to cut around the four holes. See Figure-2.

After sealing the top you slide the screen in front of the carton. Your assistant then immediately gets out of the carton and makes her appearance from behind the screen, while you are still adjusting it. As soon as she appears, you step behind the screen and get into the carton thru the rear opening. Your assistant then immediately removes the screen from in front of the carton and the audience sees that you are gone. She cuts open the top of the carton and you step out.

It is very important that you rehearse this illusion so that it is worked swiftly and smoothly. Your assistant should appear from behind the screen almost as soon as you have it in front of the carton. You must then get into the carton very quickly and quietly. She then removes the screen. The carton is only concealed for a matter of seconds. You will find this an effective illusion and one which you will enjoy working.

Victory Substitution

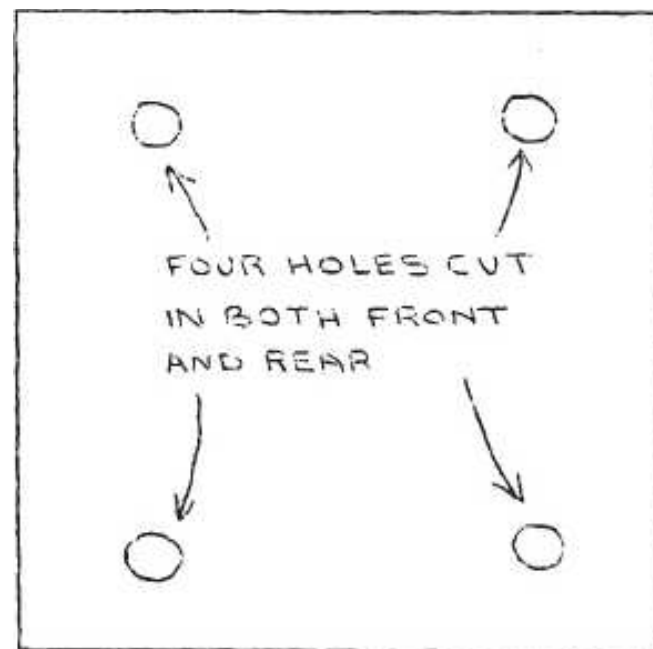


FIG. 1

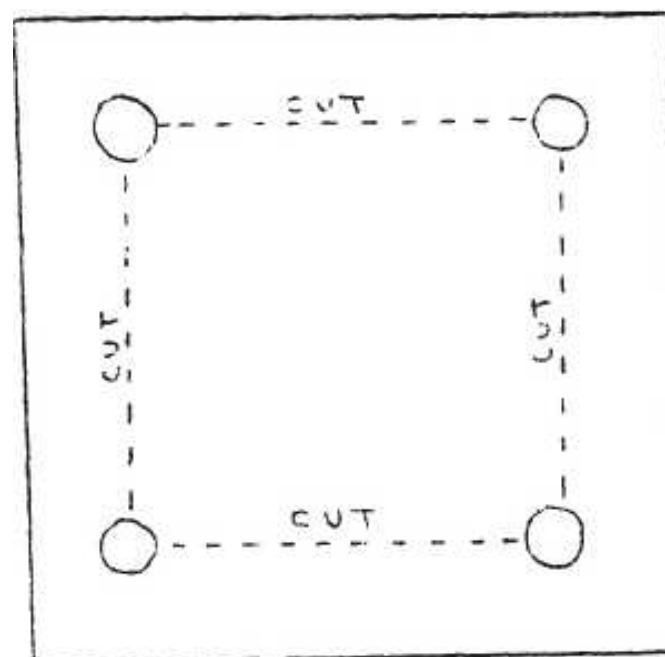


FIG. 2

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VICTORY COSTUME ILLUSION

Like the Victory Production and the Victory Substitution, simplicity is the keynote of this illusion. It has been used very successfully by performers around the country.

The carton for this miracle should be 36 inches square and 44 inches long. If you can get one of this approx. size from a store, good. If not it can be easily constructed. The carton should have no top or bottom. It will thus fold flat easier, and be more readily transported. A large opening is cut into the rear of the carton, an opening almost as large as the back panel. Reinforce all edges with tape.

Next, you will need 4 pieces of lumber, approx 1 in. by 3 in. by 44 inches long. Also required is a wooden dowel 36 in. long. If you wish, you could use another piece of 1 by 3 lumber. See Figure-1. This last piece will form the top section. Into each end of this top section piece insert a 1/4 inch diameter "hanger bolt" about 3 inches long. A hanger bolt is a standard hardware item. Each of the 1 by 3 pieces should have a hole drilled near one end thru which the hanger bolts will pass.

By fitting two of the 1 by 3 pieces to each end of the top section and securing with a wing nut and washer, you will have a rack on which to hang costumes that will come apart and pack flat. If the costumes are heavy you may want to add a horizontal support to the bottom of each of the "X" frames.

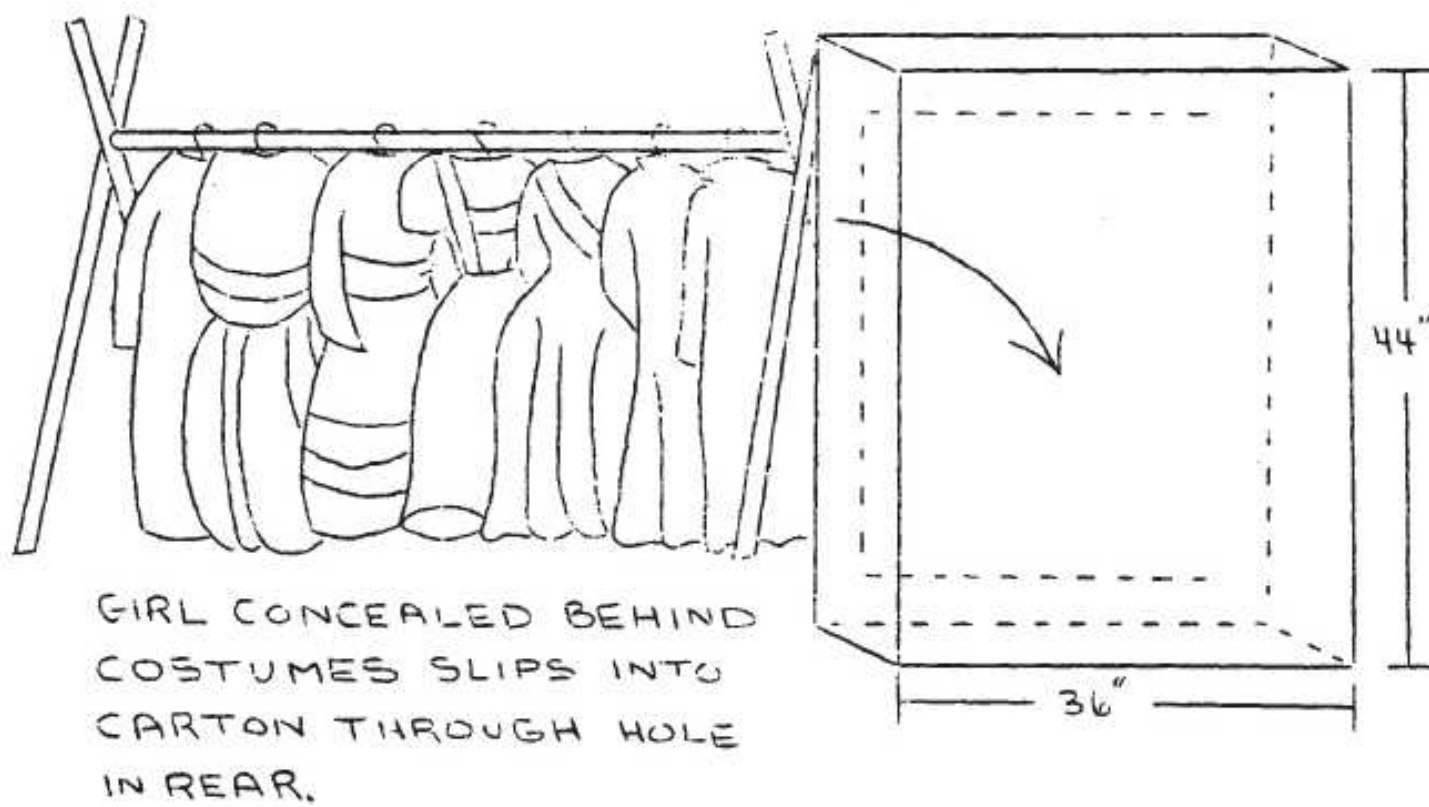
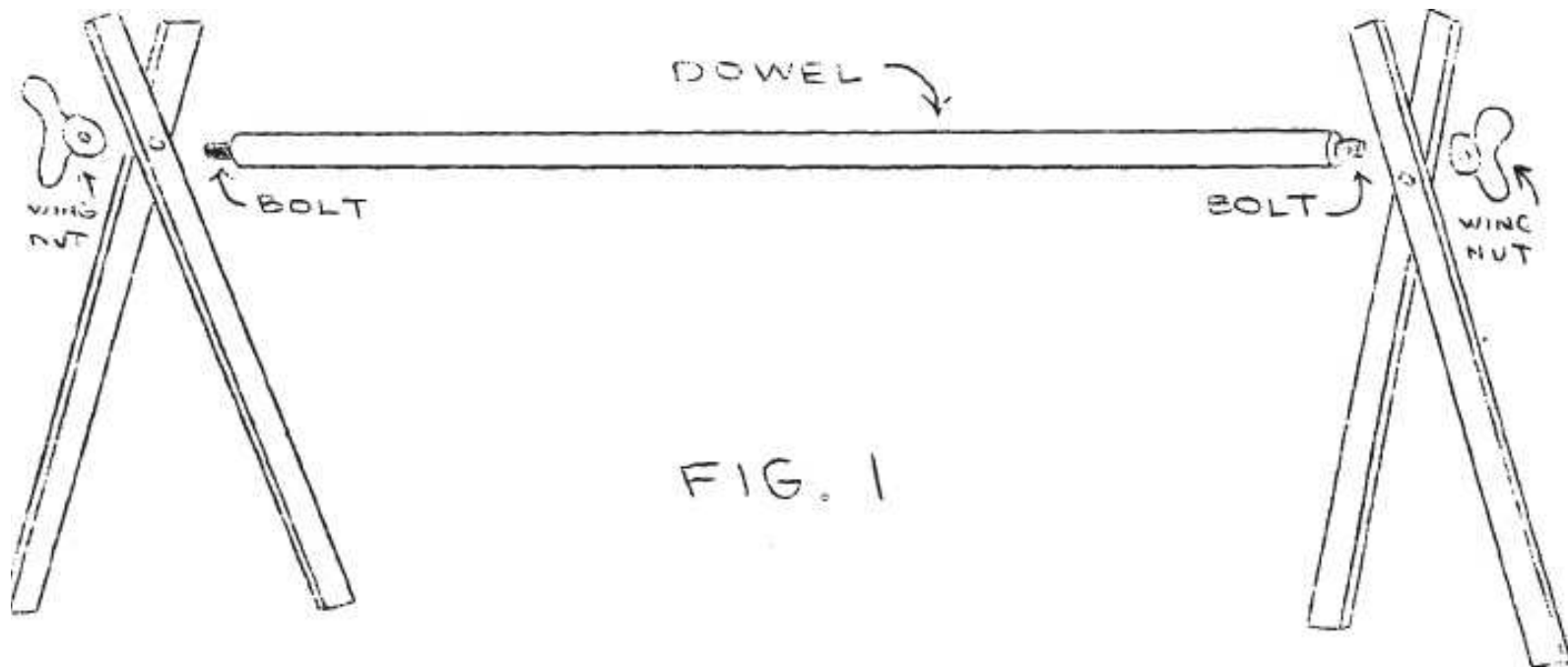
At the start, dresses representing various countries are hanging on the rack. The costumes should reach to the floor. Your girl assistant, wearing a duplicate of one of the costumes, is concealed behind the rack of dresses. The carton is folded flat. It's opening to the rear, it rests against the end of the rack.

In presenting, pick up the carton in its folded condition. Open it, and set it on the floor so that the edge of the carton

overlaps the end of the rack. See Figure-2. The girl then slips from her place of concealment and into the carton thru the hole in the rear. You then move the rack to one side.

On a tray you have a dozen or more cards on each of which is written the name of the costume which the girl is wearing. "Here I have cards on which are written the names of various costumes: Italian, English, French, Dutch, etc." You say this as you apparently read the different names. Actually, each card bears the same name. Place the cards, writing side down, on the tray and have one selected by a member of the audience. The person selecting the card reads the name aloud. You clap your hands together and the girl jumps up out of the carton dressed in the selected costume.

Victory Costume



VICTORY SPIRIT CABINET

The performer shows an unprepared carton to be empty. A slate is shown to be blank on both sides. It is placed into the carton. A hammer, nail, board, bell and tamborine are also placed inside the box. The top of the carton is then sealed. Immediately, the audience hears the hammer pounding along with the bell and tamborine ringing. Quite a comotion continues for several minutes and then suddenly all is quiet.

The top of the carton is then opened. The slate is removed and is seen to bear a written message. When the board is removed, the audience sees that the nail has been pounded into the board!!

Some of you readers may not be able to use this illusion. Those of you who do have all the necessary properties will find it a fascinating item. All of the noise the audience hears, the bell and tamorine ringing, and the hammer pounding, comes from a concealed tape recorder. It can be hidden under or behind the table, etc. The message on he slate is produced wth a flap slate. The flap being left in the carton when the slate is removed. As for the nail being pounded into the board --- it is already in the board at the start. It is concealed by the hand when it is shown at the begining. It's as simple as that

If you work this on a stage or anyplace where you are a little distance from the spectators, an assistant off stage could produce the necessary noise with duplicate items. Be certain if you use the tape recorder method that the amplifier and speakers will have enough power to produce the proper noise.

VICTORY HEADLESS ILLUSION

A bottomless box is placed over the head of an assistant from the audience. A door in front of the box is opened to show the interior. To the amazement of all, the head of the assistant has vanished. The audience looks right thru the empty box, thru a hole in the rear, and can see objects behind the box.

For this illusion construct a carton about 13 inches square and 26 inches long. The carton has no top or bottom. A partition is placed midway down in the carton. In the center of this partition, cut a circular hole 6 inches in diameter. A large square opening is then cut in the top rear of the carton. See Figure-2. In the lower front section, cut an opening 9 inches high by 12 inches wide. A door is then attached to the front of the carton so that it will cover the opening. It is hinged at the bottom thus opening downward, Figure-1.

In the lower section of the box place a mirror at a 45 degree angle to the bottom of the box. In the top section, place another mirror also at a 45 degree angle. See Figure-3. When you look into the box thru the opening in the front, you apparently see right thru the box and out the rear. Actually, you see out the back thru the reflection of the two mirrors, as indicated in Figure-4.

In presenting, always keep the front of the carton towards the spectators. Keep the door closed. Have a spectator from the audience step up and sit on a chair. Place the box over their head. Then open the door in front. The head of the person has apparently vanished. Wave your hand back and forth behind the carton and the audience will see it, apparently thru the carton. Be sure and keep your hand in constant motion. Finally, close the front door and remove the carton from their head. The head is apparently restored to its proper owner. Always work this illusion above the eye level of the audience.

By hinging the center partition and hinging the mirrors at the bottom only, the carton may be folded flat. When it is opened, the mirrors and partition will automatically fall into place. It is more effective this way.

Victory Headless

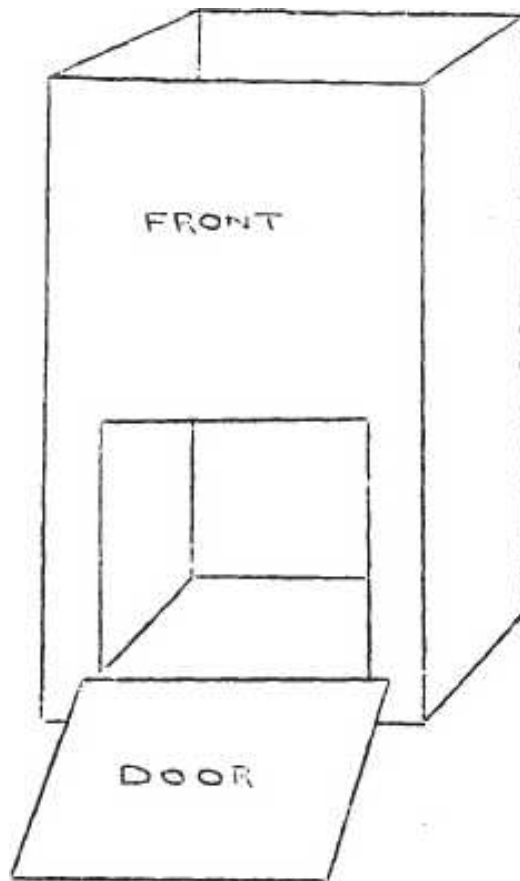


FIG. 1

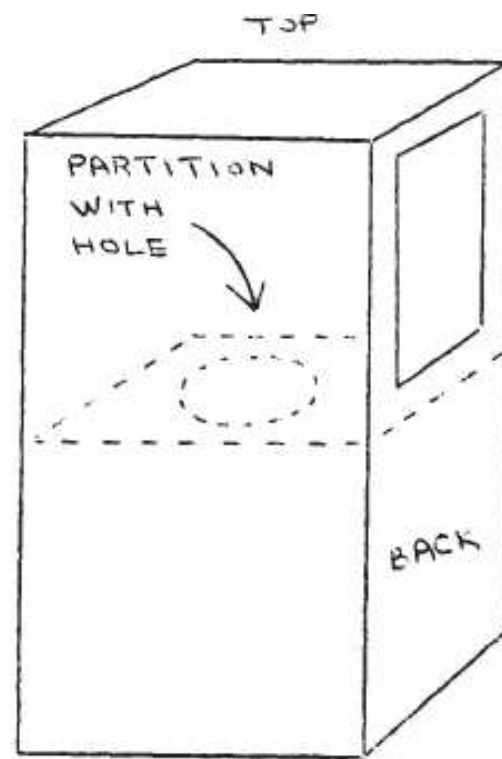
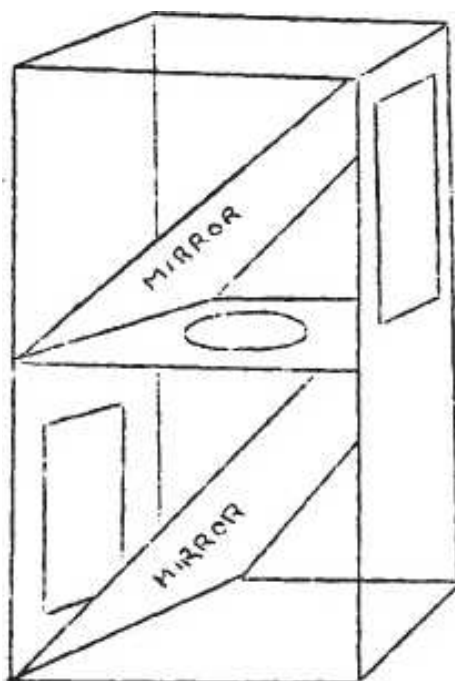


FIG. 2



SIDE VIEW
FIG. 3

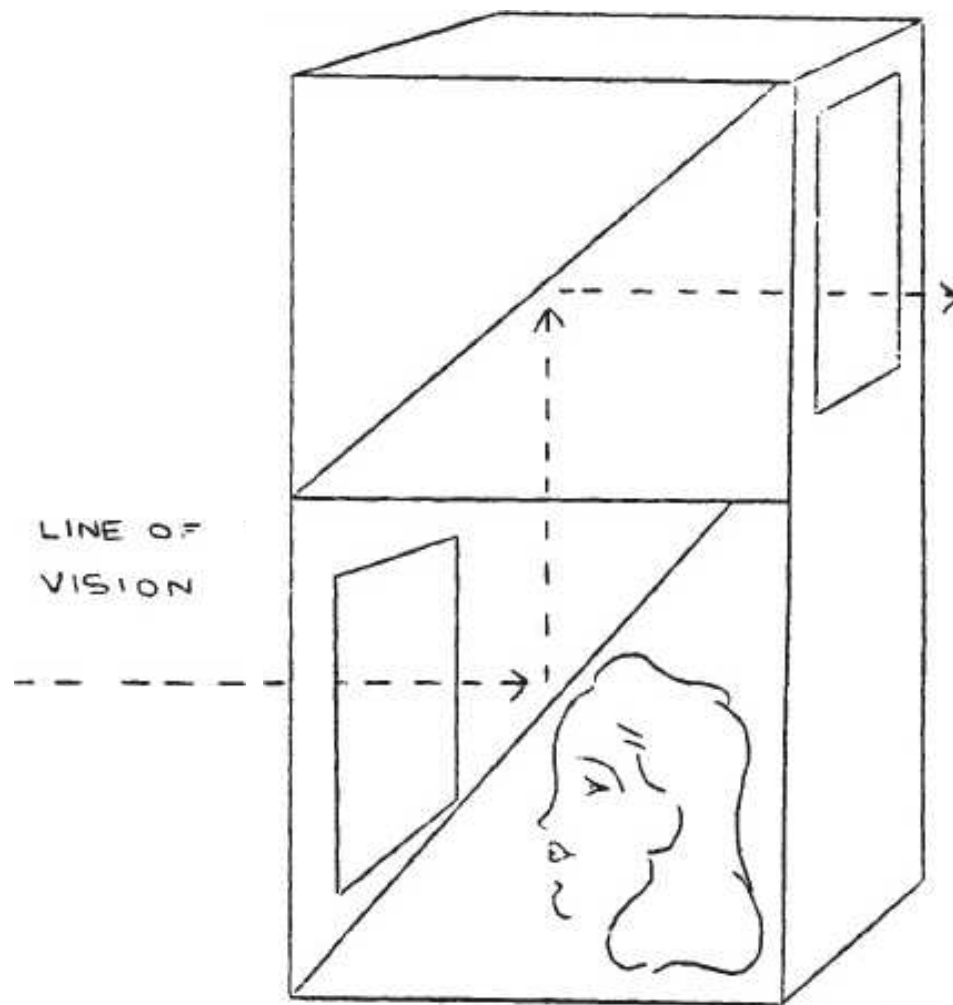


FIG. 4

VICTORY GIRL PRODUCTION

This illusion has enjoyed tremendous success and all those who have been wise enough to try it have raved over the sensation it creates.

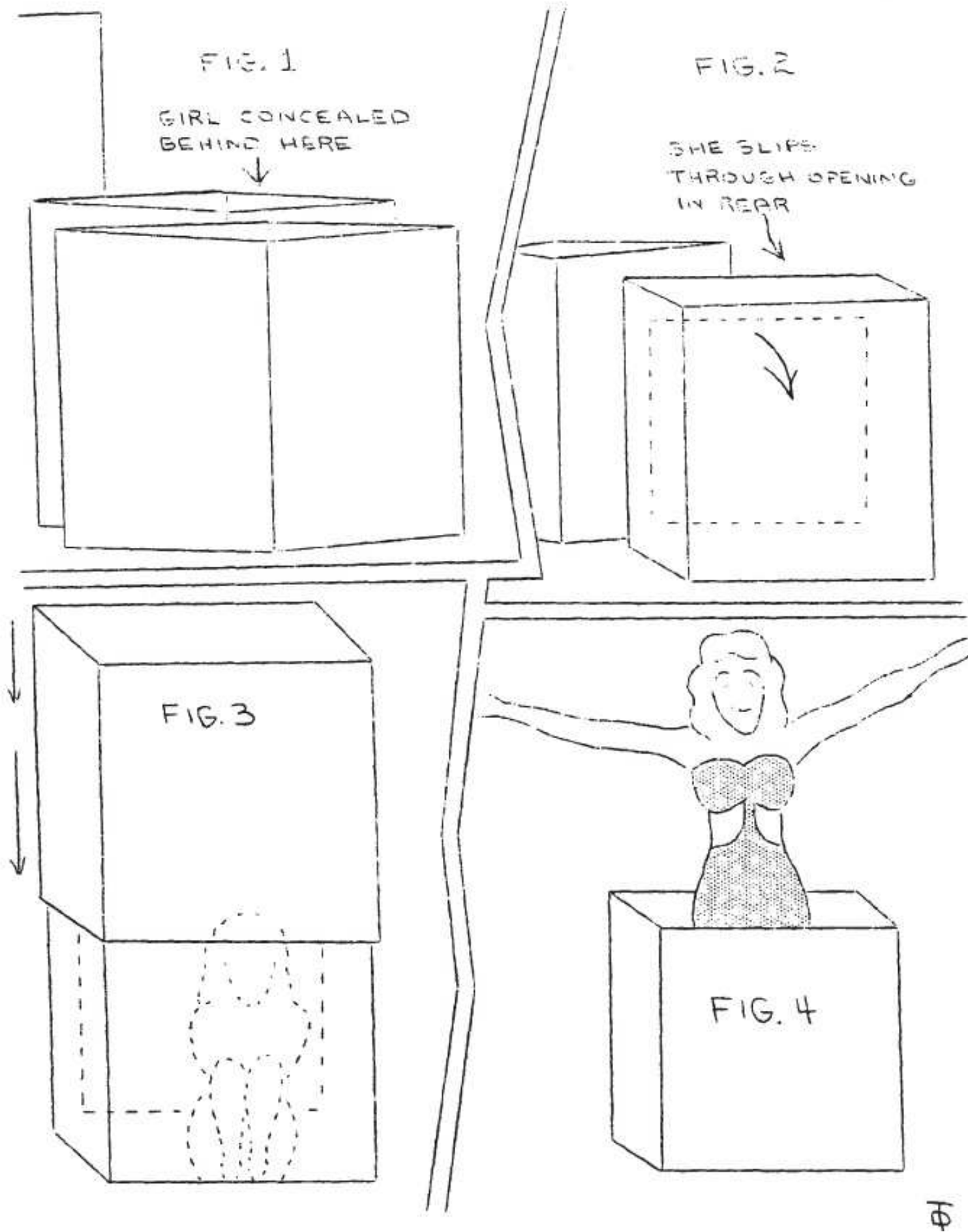
You will need two large cartons for this illusion. The tops and bottoms of both cartons are removed and the edges are reinforced with tape. One of the cartons is faked by cutting a large opening into the rear of it. This opening should be plenty large enough for your girl assistant to pass into the carton. Reinforce the edges of this opening with tape. The unfaked carton should be just slightly larger than the faked one so that it can be slid down over it.

Have both cartons folded flat and leaning against a chair. The faked one is to the front with the hole to the rear. The girl is concealed behind the cartons as shown in Figure-1. Pick up the front carton and show that it is flat. Now, open it into a box and set it down so it overlaps the remaining carton. The hole or opening is to the rear.

As this is done, the girl slips from behind the remaining folded carton and into the open one thru the opening in the rear, Figure-2. You then pick up the second carton. Show it. Open it out. Then slide it down over the faked carton, as shown in Figure-3. This, of course, covers the hole in the inner carton so the nested cartons may be turned all around while still on the floor to show all sides. You then clap your hands and the girl pops out as in Figure-4..

Bill Neff uses this method: He picks up the front carton, shows it and forms it into a square carton. Just as he places it down IN FRONT of the folded one he picks up the folded one. This leaves the girl behind the faked carton. She can then slip inside of the faked carton while he shows the unfaked one. This is a very effective move if practiced and worked smoothly.

Victory Girl Production



VICTORY SWORD BOX

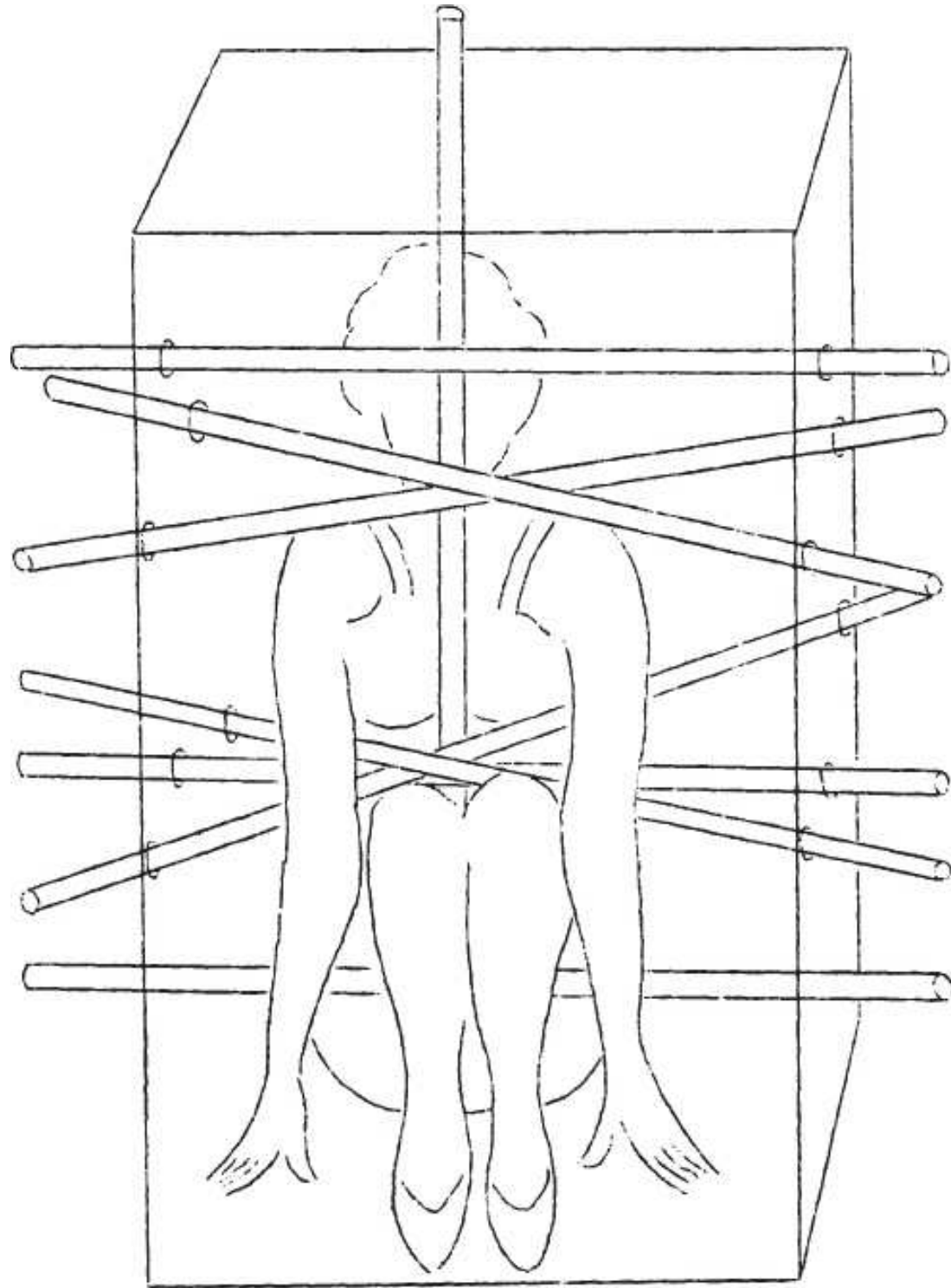
Placing an assistant in a box and then thrusting swords thru the box at all angles has always been a very perplexing illusion. Here we make use of the versatile carton for the box and 1/2 or 3/4 inch wooden dowels for the swords. The carton should be of such a size that it will just accomodate your assistant in a sitting position. Small holes are cut in the carton at the point where the dowels will penetrate. Eight dowels will be needed.

Introduce your assistant, and then have her step into the carton, facing the audience. She then sits down in this position, still facing the audience. This very important to the illusion. Once she is seated and out of sight of the audience, she turns sideways to the audience. The top of the carton is closed. As far as the audience is concerned, she is still sitting facing them. If you now take a dowel and push it thru the carton from the front to the rear, and directly in the center it whoud have to pass thru her if she were still facing front.

Since she is sitting sideways, it passes in front of her stomach. The illustration shows how the eight dowels are placed thru the carton. This is a side view for clarity. You will notice that one goes down thru the center, passing in front of her face and down thru her legs. These are placed straight thru from front to rear. Four are then criss-crossed. It would seem inconceivable that anyone could be in the carton.

After the dowels are removed, your assistant turns face front again and rises from the carton in this position. We might add that your assistant can help guide the dowels thru the holes from inside.

Sword Box



SIDE
CUT-AWAY VIEW

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VICTORY LEVITATION

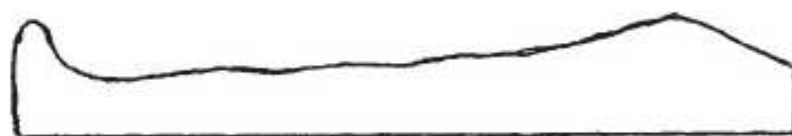
Here is a levitation which, with all materials at hand, you can build in ten to fifteen minutes!. The cost is practically nil, and it can be presented on the stage or in the parlor.

The carton used for this illusion is a "coffin" like affair. It must be large enough to be placed over your girl assistant when she is in a reclining position. The carton should have no top or bottom. There should be a metal clip on each side of the interior of the carton. Each clip holds a cardboard cut out, as illustrated in Figure-1. This cardboard cut out will help create the illusion of legs and feet during presentation. Four chairs and a sheet make up the remaining properties.

Your girl assistant is apparently hypnotized and laid across the seats of four chairs. The chairs are placed in a row with the seats facing the audience. The carton, you explain, represents a coffin. This "coffin" is then placed down over her. A sheet is then draped over the top of the carton. Your assistant, holding one end of the cardboard cut outs in each hand, then slowly rises into a sitting position. As she rises, she tilts her head back as far as she can. Figure-2 illustrates what happens. You will notice that the sheet should come up to her neck and, thus concealing everything except her head. To the audience, it appears that her entire body is floated up and out of the carton.

The sheet should be of such a length that it overlaps the top of the carton when she is in a sitting position. After a few moments, she slowly reclines; giving the illusion she is floating back down into the carton. She places the cutout back in the clips. The sheet and carton are then removed. Your assistant is apparently awakened from her hypnotic sleep and an excellent illusion comes to an end.

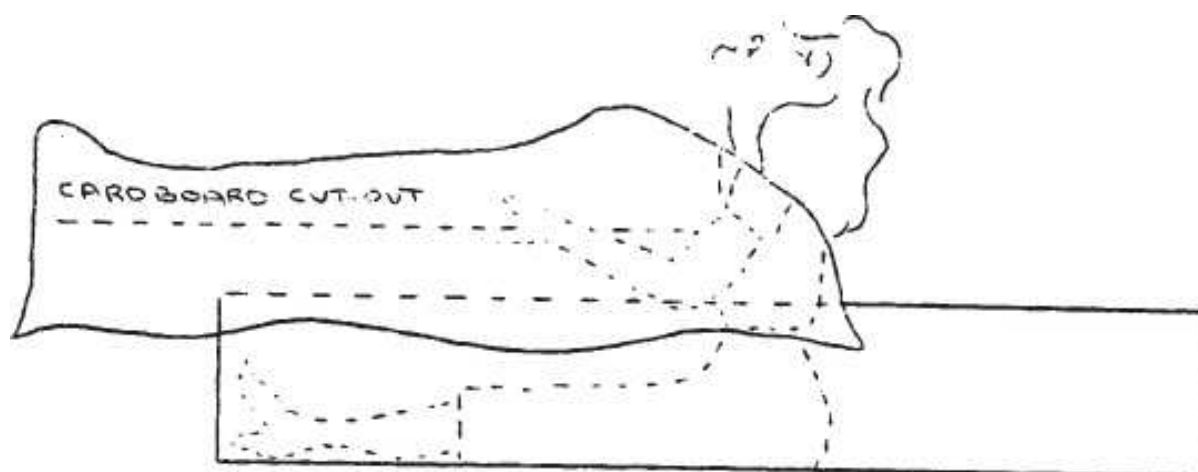
Victory Levitation



MAKE TWO CARDBOARD CUT-OUTS
LIKE THIS

FIG. 1

FIG. 2



4

THE DOLL HOUSE

The doll house has long been a favorite of club, platform, and stage magicians. If you were to buy one of the standard models it would represent a considerable investment. We believe you will find this one to be even more baffling than the expensive versions. Also, it has the advantage of being light weight and packing flat.

The house, when fully constructed, is 30 inches long by 24 inches wide and 40 inches high. It is built up right in front of the audience from flat pieces!! These dimensions were figured for a girl about 5 ft. 2 in. tall. For a taller girl, enlarge the dimensions accordingly.

The house is formed from 3 separate pieces. The front and one side are permanently hinged together. The other side is hinged to the back. The roof is the third piece. Small pin hinges are attached to the two wall sections to fasten them together when they are assembled.

A glance at the illustrations will clarify the construction details and the method by which the girl gets into the house.

At the start, the roof is standing on end, as illustrated. The girl is concealed behind it. The two wall sections are folded flat and leaning against the roof. The illusion is now ready for presentation.

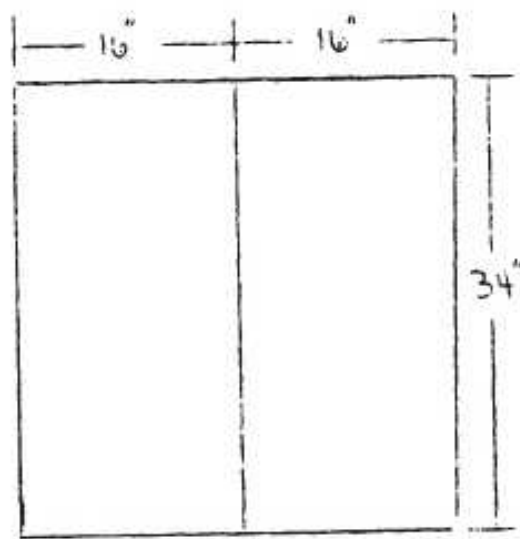
First, show a large sheet of canvas or other cloth and spread it on the floor. This precludes the idea of traps in the floor. On this, set up the front and side section. Now, take the next section, side and back, and in placing the side up to the front, allow the back to swing out so that it overlaps the edge of the roof as you fasten the side to the front. The girl can then sneak from behind the roof into the house proper without being seen.

Next, pick up the roof and show it and, after swinging the house back in place, and fastening it, place the roof on top. The illusion can be brought to a climax. At your command or signal the girl tips the roof to the rear and stands up in the house, thus making her appearance.

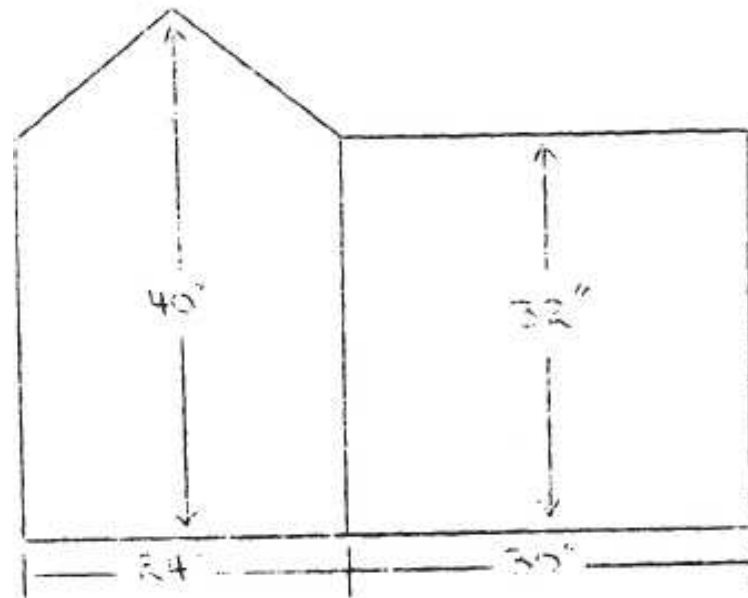
The wearing of a very full formal gown by the assistant will enhance the illusion and make it look even more impossible for the house to have contained her.

Of course, you may paint this Victory House to look like a regular doll house, but we prefer to leave it plain.

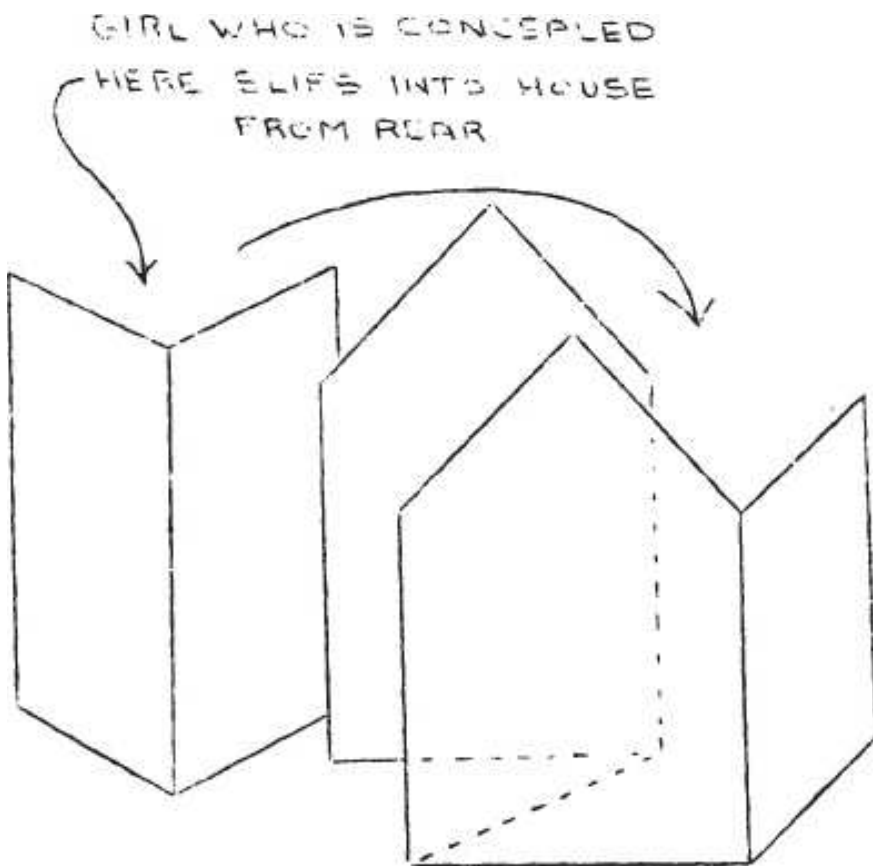
Doll House



ROOF
MAKE ONE



MAKE TWO



Φ

DOG VANISH

The vanish of a living animal has always had a certain fascination. In this illusion we give you a very simple method for vanishing a dog. Of course, any other small animal could be used.

In effect, a dog is placed into a carton and this carton is IMMEDIATELY shown to be empty.

We again make use of a tip-over box. Another illusion describes this but in this case we have one addition. In referring to the illustration, Fig.-1, you will notice that a small box has been attached to the hinged flap. This small box must also have a lid.

In performing, when you place the dog into the carton, you actually place it into the small box and close the lid. Now, when the carton is tipped over the little box containing the dog will hold the flap upright so that it appears as the bottom of the carton, Fig-2.